

Golden Master v2.5.0

Purpose: run sessions end to end without breaking governance, determinism, or export provenance.

This guide is for creators, operators, and support teams who need practical execution steps, not engineering theory.

RECOMMENDED PROFILE: FIRST SONG

RECOMMENDED MODE: FRIENDLY

CORE MODEL

- Intent -> Proposal (APL)
- Proposal -> ACC Authorization
- Authorization -> Deterministic State Change
- State -> Offline Export + Signed Provenance

Quick Start (Shortest Path)

STEP 1

Choose Profile

Pick **First Song** for guided flow.

STEP 2

Record or Upload

Use mic/interface or drag existing audio.

STEP 3

Analyze

Review loudness, dynamics, and balance.

STEP 4

Authorize Changes

Approve only understood proposals in ACC.

STEP 5

Export + Verify

Output WAV + manifest and verify marker.

Main Promise: you can move fast without blind automation. Every critical action remains reviewable, replayable, and verifiable.

SESSION SETUP

Profiles, Modes, and Device Prep

CHOICE	BEST FOR	OPERATOR OUTCOME
First Song	Beginners, guided operation	Highest assistance, lowest risk of skipped steps
Artist Fast Path	Experienced creators	Faster completion with fewer explanations
Engineer Advanced	Power users and mixers	Direct control and quicker iteration loops

PREFLIGHT CHECKLIST

- Audio route confirmed (headphones recommended)
- Browser audio resumed (Safari/iOS tap once)
- Mode selected correctly before ingest
- File naming convention set
- Goal statement written in one sentence

RECORDING BASELINE

- Mic distance: 4-8 inches
- Quiet room preferred
- One clean level-check take first
- Smart Comping for patching weak lines
- Honest Tuner for subtle correction first

Rule of thumb: if anything feels confusing, switch back to Friendly mode and execute only the next guided step.

OPERATING PROCEDURE

Standard Session SOP

STAGE A: INGEST

- Upload source or record into session
- Confirm waveform loads cleanly
- Do not batch edits before analysis completes

STAGE B: ANALYZE

- Confirm loudness/dynamics/balance are populated
- Read plain-language summary first
- Treat incomplete analysis as a blocking condition

STAGE C: PROPOSE

- Use clear prompts: “aggressive vocals + slap delay”
- Review Intelligence Feed proposals one by one
- Skip unclear proposals

STAGE D: AUTHORIZE

- Hold proposal button to arm
- Press **Enter** to confirm
- Verify state hash/history update after execution

STAGE E: REVIEW

- Use loudness-matched A/B only
- Check active chain matches intent
- Reject over-bright or over-limited outcomes

STAGE F: EXPORT

- WAV for archive/delivery
- MP3 for approval/share
- Use queue when continuing active edits

Do not authorize what you cannot explain. The fastest safe workflow is selective approval, not blanket approval.

GOVERNANCE + DETERMINISM

ACC Enforcement and Timeline Safety

LOW RISK

Read-only and low-cost actions.

Often auto-approved under Co-Pilot/Full Autonomy.

MEDIUM RISK

State-mutating actions with moderate impact.

Typically review-gated except autonomy presets.

HIGH RISK

Destructive/heavy/export-level actions.

Explicit ACC approval required.

DETERMINISTIC TIMELINE RULES

- Use history scrub as read-only preview first.
- Use **Restore** explicitly before rewriting forward history.
- Create branches before risky experimental edits.
- Merge only after conflict review (OURS/THEIRS decision).
- Treat state hash mismatches as incident-level issues.

Threat model in one line: tamper-evident history, replay-protected execution, cryptographically verified output.

STEMS + CONTENT

Stems, Arrangement, Collaboration, and Video

STEM STRATEGY

- Manual stems: highest control and accuracy
- Splitter fallback: use confidence to decide next step
- **High confidence:** continue
- **Medium confidence:** continue with caution
- **Low confidence:** source manual stems for release

ARRANGEMENT + REVISION

- Label Intro/Verse/Chorus/Bridge/Outro
- Duplicate sections for alt options
- Revision comments must be specific and measurable
- Use compare mode before final sign-off

ACTION	MODE	WHEN TO USE
Record directly	Single Track	Fastest path from idea to mix/master
Isolate control	Stems	When vocal/drum/bass separation matters
Prompt generation	AI Studio	Ideation and structured proposal pipelines
Content packaging	Video	Post-master social clip generation

EXPORT ASSURANCE

Provenance Verification Runbook

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES PER EXPORT

- `.wav` (or `.mp3`)
- `.manifest.json` sidecar
- Verified embedded provenance marker for WAV/MP3

QUICK MARKER CHECK (WAV)

Run from terminal at project root:

```
node -e "const fs=require('fs');const b=fs.readFileSync(process.argv[1]);console.log(b.includes(Buffer.from('ESL_PROVENANCE_REF'))?'marker-present':'marker-missing')"/exported-track.wav
```

Expected output: **marker-present**

MANIFEST FIELDS TO VALIDATE

- `signature`
- `manifestHash`
- `signatureAlgorithm`
- Entries map to approved actions

NO-GO TRIGGERS

- Missing sidecar manifest
- Marker missing in WAV/MP3
- ACC bypass behavior observed
- Determinism gate failure in CI

TROUBLESHOOTING + SUPPORT

Operator Incident Response

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	CORRECTIVE ACTION
No sound on iPhone/iPad	Safari audio context suspended	Tap resume/play once in-player
Proposal does not execute	Not armed, ACC blocked, or policy denied	Hold to arm, press Enter, inspect policy reason
Export failed or absent	Render/signing path interrupted	Re-run export and verify manifest endpoint availability
Unexpected session close	Refresh/crash/navigation	Restore session and verify hash continuity

SUPPORT ESCALATION PACKET

- Exact repro steps
- Device / browser / OS version
- Timestamp
- Copy Debug Info payload
- If export issue: WAV + manifest + marker-check result

Escalation quality rule: one complete packet is better than multiple partial reports.

DAILY OPERATIONS

Checklists + Release Gate

START OF DAY

- Confirm version/build
- Confirm output device path
- Run ingest+analyze smoke pass

DURING SESSION

- Branch before risky edits
- Approve only understood proposals
- A/B before any export sign-off

END OF DAY

- Archive final audio + manifest
- Document unresolved issues
- Record deliverable status

GO / NO-GO CRITERIA

- **GO**: determinism gate passed, exports signed, marker present, A/B approved.
- **NO-GO**: any ACC bypass signal, provenance mismatch, or determinism failure.

Final reference: Echo Sound Lab removes production friction, but operator taste and approval remain the final authority.